

Case Form Usability Test Plan

US Tax Court Case Management Tool Project
January 2019

Overview

Flexion UX researchers will conduct a usability study for the “Start a Case” form functionality of the USTC case management tool. The study is designed to gather feedback from participants who will use the case management tool to file petitions.

We will conduct a combination of remote and in-person interviews with participants screened and selected by Flexion.

Goals

- Evaluate a clickable prototype representing the design of the “Start a Case” form, in order to:
 - Discover any usability issues
 - Gauge the level of satisfaction with the design
 - Determine the perceived ease of use of the design
- Resolve open questions regarding the case form:
 - Does the user have enough information to successfully file the petition online?
 - Does the form order follow the petitioner’s expected workflow?
 - Is it easy to understand which fields are required?
 - Is terminology clear or do users need clarification?
 - Are instructions clear and helpful?
 - Does the form design efficiently support the user’s need to complete the required task of filing a petition online?

Participants

Flexion will recruit 15-20 participants with the goal of completing 8-12 interviews. The target participant mix will be:

- No more than 25% of participants from a single geographic region:
 - Southwest
 - Midwest
 - Northeast
 - Southeast
- We will ask the participants for their specific state, to see if the location restrictions for cases are understood.
- Diverse gender mix, if possible - target is 50/50, male/female

- US taxpayers age 18 and over. Target age ranges, with no more than 50% from a single range:
 - o 18-30
 - o 31- 40
 - o 41-50
 - o 51-65
 - o 66+
- Internet usage, balance of frequent vs occasional

Recruiting Schedule

Flexion will reach out to friends and family via social media and personal connections. Interested parties will respond to Valencia Bey with availability, and she will schedule all interviews.

Interviews will take place from January 22nd- 27th. If the level of participation is low or if interviews are challenging to schedule, additional interviews may be conducted the week of January 29th.

In order to accommodate as many participants as possible, Flexion will schedule interviews with participants between the hours of 8am and 6pm EST, Monday through Friday. If additional flexibility is needed, Flexion will make reasonable accommodations.

Findings Analysis and Presentation

Beginning January 22nd, daily updates will be provided during standup on recruiting efforts, interviews scheduled and interviews completed. Within one week of the conclusion of interviews, study results will be shared with the internal UX design team. Within two days of the internal team review, the results analysis will be shared with the USTC team.

Methodology

Interviews will be 30 minutes in length and will be conducted remotely using the Zoom meeting tool for screen sharing. In-person interviews will also be conducted where feasible. The Flexion design team will conduct interviews and take notes during sessions.

The “Start a Case” form prototype will be used for all sessions:

<http://ui-stg.ustc-case-mgmt.flexion.us>

Username: taxpayer

Participants will receive a sample notice via email when they have confirmed their testing slot. They will be asked to save the notice to their hard drive before the test so that it can be easily accessed during the test. Users will also be asked to test the Zoom software prior to the test, to ensure they are able to open and use the tool. If users have trouble using the tool, the

moderator will attempt to walk them through the process. Alternate tools are available for participants who have issues using Zoom (like join.me, Skype, GoToMeeting).

The moderator will provide a brief introduction, including background information, during the test. Participants will be encouraged to use the think-aloud protocol, meaning they will be encouraged to talk through tasks as they complete them, allowing the moderator to understand their thought process as they move through tasks.

Introduction

Thank you for agreeing to spend time with us today. As we mentioned in the invitation, Flexion is designing a tool for the US Tax Court to allow taxpayers to file cases online. As part of this process, we're gathering feedback from taxpayers on our early designs.

Today we'll be taking a look at the case filing process. I have a prototype I'll share with you that we will use today. The prototype is a work in progress, so not every feature is functional. Using the prototype, I'll ask you to access, review and complete a "Start a Case" form as if you were a taxpayer who has received a notice from the IRS. Were you able to download the .pdf we sent?

While you're completing the tasks, I ask that you think aloud, so that I can understand your thought process and the decisions you make. I may ask you questions about your process, and I want to stress that there are no wrong answers. We're testing the prototype, and not you, so you can't make any mistakes. Any information you share with me will be helpful and I'll make note of it. Our goal is to make the tool as easy and user friendly as possible, and your feedback will help us understand what works well, and also help us understand where we might be able to make improvements or adjustments. Also, your comments today are anonymous and your name won't be associated with any feedback you share.

Do you have any questions before we begin?

If the participant has downloaded the .pdf to their hard drive, continue to Scenario 1.

If the participant has not downloaded the .pdf, walk them through the process, then continue to Scenario 1.

Scenario 1 - Landing Page

Goal: Gather participant feedback on case form access from the Landing page.

You've received an IRS notice that states the IRS has determined you owe \$3,487. You don't think you owe this amount and have evidence to back that up. You log into the USTC site and this is the page you see. How would you begin to file your petition? What would you do first?

Task	Description	Notes/Observations		
1	View Landing page			
2	Navigate to the “Start a Case” form - Probe, Start a Case label			
	Additional feedback - Probe, any other information they would find helpful			

Things to consider:

- Did the participant notice that the correct action was available?
- Did the participant associate the correct action with the desired task?
- Did the participant perform the correct action?
- If the participant did not perform the correct action, why?

Scenario 2 - Start a Case

Goal: Gather participant feedback on case form .

You’ve selected Start a Case, and now you see the Start a Case form. How would you go about filing your petition using this form?

Task	Description	Notes/Observations		
1	View the Start a Case form			

1a	Instructions about PDF and what's needed to file case	
2	Required fields	
3	Notice type - Probe Does the user know how to figure out which type of notice they have from the PDF notice they received?	
3a	Notice date - Probe re: format	
3b	Additional notes for notice	
4	Petition upload	
4a	Additional notes for petition	
5	How do you want the case to be handled? Case Procedure Probe, Small Case or Regular Case: - Probe, if needed: Why do	

	you think the Small Case or Regular case is the best? - Helper text - Note user preference Note: We want to know if they understand the difference between Small and Regular	
5a	Select Case Procedure Probe: - Does the field label make sense? Can they understand what they are selecting here? - Is the user able to find their state - If there is no place for them to hear a small case, make sure to capture this information - Probe: If a regular case is not in Vermont and a small case is., what are the user's thoughts around that?	
6	Digital Signature checkbox	

	- Are instructions clear? - Is any information missing?	
7	Cancel button <i>What would you expect to happen when you select the Cancel button?</i> - What does a user expect to happen when clicking the Cancel button? Ask the user to click the cancel button Goal is to ensure the messaging is clear. Gather feedback from the user on the behavior of the cancel button Ask user to click No, continue to return to form to exit the cancellation process	
8	Submit button	

	- What does a user expect to happen when clicking the Submit button	
8a	Success message	
9	Probe: Order of information, is it logical?	
10	Probe: Do you know what will happen next with the case? What information would you expect to receive?	
	Additional feedback	

Things to consider:

- Does the user understand what information they need to have before they file a petition online, what documents are needed?
- Does the user have enough information to get started at this point?
- Does the participant understand what fields are required?
- Are the helper text boxes useful for the participant?
- Does the user understand the difference in case types?
- Does the user understand the difference in case procedure -- small vs. regular?

Scenario 3 - Access a Case from the Dashboard

Goal: Gather participant feedback on accessing a case from the dashboard

Now I'm going to ask you to return to the dashboard. How would you expect to access the case you just created? I'd like to find out your thoughts regarding accessing the case you just created..

Task	Description	Notes/Observations		
1	Access new case from the dashboard. - Is it clear how the user would access their case information? - Did the user experience any challenges when trying to access the case information?			
	Additional feedback - Probe, any other information they would find helpful on the dashboard			

Scenario 4 - Error messaging

Goal: Gather participant feedback on error messaging

Now I'm going to ask you to return to select Start a Case. When the case form displays, please navigate to the bottom of the page and click the Submit button. I'd like to find out what you think about error messaging.

Task	Description	Notes/Observations		
1	Page level error messaging			

	- Is this what the user expected to see? - Is the error messaging helpful? - Did the user expect to see field level error messaging? Why or why not?	
	Additional feedback	

Things to consider:

- Is error messaging clear?
- Is the placement of error messaging useful? Why or why not?
- Does the participant understand what action needs to be taken to resolve the error?

Thank you for your time today. This concludes the study.